



First Sprint Planner

Book Reference: Chapter 11 – What to Do Next Instrument Type: Synthesis / Action Plan

Purpose

Every instrument in this book isolates one piece of the system. This one pulls them together. The First Sprint Planner takes your readiness score, your constraint, your team, and your chosen path — and reduces them to a single page you can act on Monday morning.

You have read the model. You understand the stages. Now write down what you are going to do.

Part 1: Where Do You Stand?

Pull your AI Readiness Scorecard from Chapter 1. Look at your scores across the five dimensions.

If you are mostly Red: Start with Signal. Name one constraint. Put a number on it. That is your entire first sprint goal. Do not try to run the full Sequence yet — get one clean Signal and build from there.

If you are mixed Red and Yellow: Start with Signal and Source. Name the constraint, then map what you already know about it — the workflows, the people, the data. Two phases. One sprint.

If you are mostly Yellow and Green: You are ready for a full sprint. Start with Signal, move through the Sequence. The instruments from Chapters 4 through 9 will guide each phase.

Action Step: If you have not completed the AI Readiness Scorecard yet, go back to Chapter 1 and do it now. It takes ten minutes and tells you exactly where to start.

Part 2: Name Your Constraint

Answer three questions. This is the minimum viable Signal — the seed that the full Signal process (Chapter 4) will refine.

1. **What is the one operational problem that is costing you the most money or time right now?**
Write one sentence — one specific, observable problem.
2. **What does it cost per year?** Write a number. Even a rough estimate works. If you cannot estimate it, that tells you something — your first sprint goal might be measuring it.

3. **What would have to be true for it to be solved?** Write one sentence. This tells you whether the constraint is Sprint-solvable or whether something upstream needs to move first.

If you can answer all three, you have the seed of a Signal.

Part 3: Identify Your Team

You need three roles filled. Not three hires. Three seats at the table.

- **Who owns the workflow where the constraint lives?** That person is your Human Orchestrator candidate. They do not need to be technical. They need to own the outcome.
Name: _____
- **Who are the 2-3 people closest to the problem daily?** They are in the room for Signal and Source. They see what the reports do not show.
Names: _____, _____
- **Do you have someone who can build?** Internal developer, external partner, or Compound membership. That is your technical resource.
Name / Resource: _____

Pro Tip: You do not need permission from IT. You do not need an AI strategy document. You need one constraint, one orchestrator, and one builder. Everything else follows.

Part 4: Pick Your Path

Two paths. Same framework. Same logic. The difference is speed and support, not methodology.

Path A: Run It Yourself

Use the instruments from each chapter to guide the sprint:

- **Signal** (Chapter 4) — Define the constraint with precision
- **Source** (Chapter 5) — Map the knowledge around it
- **Design** (Chapter 6) — Architect the solution
- **Build** (Chapter 7) — Construct and test
- **Deliver** (Chapter 8) — Deploy and validate
- **Compound** (Chapter 9) — Extract the reusable pattern

Set the quarterly rhythm from Chapter 10 to make it repeatable. Each sprint sharpens your operating model. Each cycle compounds.

Path B: Run It with Compound

- **Book a Clarity Call** (30 minutes, no cost) — an operator walks through your constraint with you and tells you whether it is Sprint-ready
- **Access the Compound Bench** — six coaching agents, one per sprint phase, that run the same logic as the worksheets in this book
- **Access the Skills Library** — twelve structured instruments that automate the analytical work behind each phase

The tools run the same methodology. They run it faster and more persistently than paper can.

Part 5: Your One-Page First Sprint Plan

This is the deliverable. Fill it in.

FIRST SPRINT PLAN — _____
[Company Name]

MY CONSTRAINT (best guess — Signal will refine it):

ESTIMATED ANNUAL COST:

MY TEAM:
Human Orchestrator: _____
In the room for Signal/Source: _____
Technical resource: _____

MY PATH: ☐ Self-guided ☐ With Compound

FIRST STEP:
☐ Schedule the Signal session with my team
☐ Book a Clarity Call at compound.co/clarify

TARGET QUARTER: _____

Action Step: Fill in the one-page plan. Right now. Before you close this book. The plan does not have to be perfect — it has to exist. A written plan you can see is worth infinitely more than a perfect plan you will get to next month.

Populated Example

FIRST SPRINT PLAN – Greenline Home Services
[Company Name]

MY CONSTRAINT (best guess – Signal will refine it):
Scheduling and dispatch takes our office manager 3 hours/day
of manual coordination – roughly \$45K/year in time that could
be spent on customer experience.

ESTIMATED ANNUAL COST:
\$45,000

MY TEAM:
Human Orchestrator: Dana (Owner)
In the room for Signal/Source: Maria (Office Manager)
James (Lead Technician)
Technical resource: Self-guided using book instruments

MY PATH: ☒ Self-guided ☐ With Compound

FIRST STEP:
☒ Schedule the Signal session with my team
☐ Book a Clarity Call at compound.co/clarity

TARGET QUARTER: Q3 2026

Greenline is a \$3M revenue home services company. The constraint is visible, measurable, and owned by someone in the room. Dana scheduled the Signal session for the following Monday. The office manager and lead technician — the two people who feel the constraint every day — will be there. No committee. No strategy deck. One constraint, one team, one Monday.

Summary

The First Sprint Planner reduces the entire book to a single decision: what are you going to do, with whom, and when.

You now have a readiness score, a named constraint, a team, a path, and a target date. That is more than most organizations have after six months of AI strategy work. You built it in the time it took to read one chapter.

Handoff

Your sprint plan points forward. The resources that support it:

- **Appendix A** contains the complete instrument library — every worksheet from every chapter, organized by sprint phase, ready to print or copy.
- **Appendix B** maps the Compound Sprint to common operational scenarios, so you can see how other

companies structured their first sprint.

- **compound.co/clarity** is where Path B starts — a 30-minute call with an operator who has run this process across dozens of companies.

The framework works. The instruments work. The only variable left is whether you start.

Start.